A SMALL-PARTY PRINTABLE

Party Budget One-Pager

Money worries sneak into party planning through the side door. This sheet brings them out into one clear table — estimated, spent, and the small difference between them — so the only surprise at the end of the night is how little of it there was to fear.

How to use it

1. Write your whole budget on the top line *first*, before filling any category. It gives every choice below a shape to fit into.
2. Estimate every category, even roughly. Rough numbers tame the fear faster than exact ones ever have.
3. As you spend, fill in **Actual** — on paper, with a pen, no app required. This page does all the math a party needs.
4. Update the “left to spend” box when it's calm, not when it's scary. It's subtraction, and subtraction can't ambush you.
5. Money feeling tight midway? Page 3 is a list of friendly trades — most budgets bend a lot more than they break.

What's inside

- **Page 2** — the one page: categories, estimate vs. actual, totals.
- **Page 3** — friendly trades, worth-every-cent items, and a per-person check.

> **A kind note:** a budget is a kindness to future-you, not a grade on this party. Nobody at the table will know what the napkins cost.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

Party Budget One-Pager

Party: _____ Date: _____ My whole budget: $ _____

Category	Estimate	Actual	Difference (+/−)
Food & main dishes			
Drinks & ice			
Tableware & napkins			
Decor & flowers			
Games, music & activities			
Go-home treats & favors			
Space, rentals or fees			
Invites, stamps & thank-you cards			
(your own category)			
(your own category)			
Total			

Left to spend

Whole budget $ _____ minus actual total $ _____ = $ _____ *and if that number is small, page 3 is your friend.*

Friendly Trades

Most budgets bend more than they break — here's where they bend kindly.

Good trades when money feels tight

- ☐ Make it a potluck — mains and drinks carry the biggest slice.
- ☐ Coffee, tea and lemonade instead of a full bar; the punch bowl forgives.
- ☐ Borrow cups, plates and chairs — two neighbors usually cover a party.
- ☐ Printables and a string of lights instead of bought decor.
- ☐ Skip favors and favors' shipping; the thank-you notes matter more.
- ☐ Smaller menu of better food — a feast of five beats twelve so-so.

Worth every cent (write yours here)

- _____
- _____
- _____

Name them now so spending later feels chosen, not chaotic.

Per-person reality check

Total actual $ _____ ÷ people _____ = $ _____ per person.

A number that's easy to say out loud — handy for right-sizing portions and for deciding between optional extras.

Said kindly: “we can afford it” and “we can't, so we'll make it smaller” are both fine answers. What's tiring is not knowing — and now you do.